The Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) Protests at Jantar Mantar, New Delhi (May–November 2026): A Sourced Timeline and Dataset for a D3.js Visualisation

The CJP protests went through two phases. The first was a 49-day agitation at Jantar Mantar (6 June – 25 July 2026) over the NEET-UG 2026 paper leak, and it succeeded: Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan resigned on 25 July Wikipedia after a 26-day hunger strike by Sonam Wangchuk and a violently dispersed 20 July "Sansad Chalo" march. christiandaily The second phase, from October 2026, is an anti-SIR campaign against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar. In this phase the state escalated sharply: thousands of detentions on 10 October, Al Jazeera Jantar Mantar de-notified as a protest site on 11–12 October, and the jailing of CJP co-convenors Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka in Tihar after they "breached" the site on 13 October. india + 2 The movement is still active (Kochi rally, 7 November) theweek and a Supreme Court-appointed inquiry into the July police violence is pending. barandbench theweek

TL;DR

- **How it started and grew:** Abhijeet Dipke, a Boston University-trained communications strategist, launched the CJP online on 16 May 2026, the day after CJI Surya Kant's "cockroaches" remark. BusinessToday (21 May) reported that it passed 3 million Instagram followers in 78 hours and crossed 9 million on 20 May, overtaking the BJP's official handle (about 8.7 million); it had 20 million by 22 May. It moved to the streets with a permitted one-day Jantar Mantar protest on 6 June (hundreds attended), then held an indefinite sit-in from 20 June. Wangchuk's fast from 28 June gave it national weight.
- **Police and government response:** police tactics escalated from cutting water and lights (20 June) to Section 163 BNSS orders and batons, tear gas, pellet guns (RAF fired 7 rounds) and reported nail-fitted batons on 20 July. A Delhi Police statement said more than 118 personnel were injured, including officers up to special commissioner rank and several women officers; the count later rose to 130+. About 60 protesters were injured by police count. Newslaundry, citing Indian Express hospital sources, reported around 100 injured people at RML Hospital's emergency by 5.30 pm, including 10 police personnel, with 4 protesters in the ICU. The CJP claims about 150 were hospitalised. The government first called the CJP a "B-team of terrorists" and then conceded: Pradhan resigned, cases were to be withdrawn, and compensation was promised.
- **After July:** in October the state shifted to pre-emption rather than negotiation. Reports put 10 October detentions anywhere from about 2,000 (an MHA official, cited by Reuters via Al Jazeera) to 15,000 (CJP claim). Jantar Mantar was stripped of its 33-year protest-site status, and Das and Ranka spent 7 days in Tihar. Treat every figure as contested; the dataset below keeps each claim separate and labels who made it.

Key Findings

1. **The trigger and the satire worked as a mobilising device.** The movement's name, mascot and membership "criteria" (unemployed, lazy, chronically online, able to rant) turned a judicial insult into an identity. Wikipedia Its grievances quickly narrowed to one demand: Pradhan's resignation over NEET-UG 2026 and CBSE On-Screen Marking errors. NEET-UG was cancelled on 12 May; the NTA notice, cited by Deccan Herald, said nearly 22.79 lakh

candidates had taken the exam at 5,400+ centres, and ETV Bharat reported fee refunds of more than Rs 300 crore.

2. **Escalation followed police and government overreach.** Each attempt to suppress the protest was followed by a jump in attention and turnout: the X account block (21 May), the "B-team of terrorists" remark (about 23 June), the forcible removal of Wangchuk to hospital (18 July), and the 20 July crackdown. Wikipedia + 2 Outlook's ground report describes the movement as a fringe story for nearly three weeks until Wangchuk's fast. outlookindia
3. **20 July is the pivotal data point, and the most contested.** Police and protester accounts differ on who used violence first (stone-pelting vs. unprovoked baton charges), on detentions (CJP said about 70; police later denied detaining anyone), Wikipedia and on the "stone truck". A Newslaundry investigation found the truck had been in police custody since 16 July; police confirmed this but called conspiracy claims baseless. Wikipedia
4. **The October phase is a different kind of story.** The issue (SIR electoral rolls), the opponent (the CEC) and the state posture (mass preventive detention, internet shutdowns, de-notification of the site) all differ from the summer. Al Jazeera + 2 The visualisation should treat it as a separate phase, not a continuation.
5. **Media coverage split sharply.** Mainstream Hindi and English TV largely ignored or delegitimised the protests at first, and crowds chanted "Godi media" at TV crews. newslaundry altnews Independent outlets (Newslaundry, The Wire, Scroll, Alt News, BOOM, The Caravan) documented police violence and debunked misinformation. Foreign outlets (AP, Reuters, Al Jazeera, BBC, CNN, Guardian, NBC, DW, Time) framed it as India's largest youth or Gen Z protest in years. Wikipedia + 2

Details

1. Origins (15–31 May 2026)

- **Trigger (15 May):** A CJI Surya Kant–led bench, hearing a contempt plea about senior-advocate designation, compared some unemployed youth who turn to media, social media and RTI activism to "cockroaches" and "parasites". dainikjagranmpcg Kant later said he had been misquoted and was referring to people with fake degrees. Wikipedia
- **Founding (16 May):** Abhijeet Dipke (born 29 Sept 1995, Aurangabad; Boston University MSc in public relations; AAP social-media volunteer 2020–23) launched the CJP from the US. Wikipedia The website tagline was "Voice of the Lazy & Unemployed". Dipke says he used AI tools (Claude, ChatGPT) to build the website and manifesto. The name parodies the BJP. Wikipedia Wikipedia
- **Manifesto (satirical but pointed):** no Rajya Sabha seats for retired CJIs; arrest of the CEC under UAPA if legitimate votes are deleted; 50% reservation for women; cancellation of Adani- and Ambani-owned media licences; a 20-year ban for defecting legislators. Wikipedia
- **Early growth (organiser and media figures):**
  - 3 million Instagram followers within 78 hours (BusinessToday, 21 May); 9 million+ on 20 May, surpassing @bjp4india's roughly 8.7 million; over 20 million by 22 May.
  - The Tribune reported 3.7 million followers in 24 hours. Wikipedia
  - X followers are disputed: about 200,000 (BBC) vs. 165,500 as of 21 May (BusinessToday).
  - 350,000+ online sign-ups claimed (Al Jazeera). Wikipedia
  - WION reported over 100,000 members "within days". wionews

    - By late June, reports cited 22 million followers. yahoo
- **Spokespeople:** Saurav Das, Vijeta Dahiya and Ashutosh Ranka were the first three. Vaishnavi Gaur, Aafreen Nawaz, Deepak Baliyan and Ratna Singh (later legal head) were added. Wikipedia Wikipedia Later office-bearers include Ajinkya Shinde (national organisation in-charge) and Vijay Mallangi (South India in-charge). outlookindia + 3
- **State pushback:**
    - MeitY ordered the X account withheld in India under Section 69A of the IT Act, citing IB inputs on "national security" (21 May). The account reportedly had about 90,000 followers at the time (Indian Express); this conflicts with BusinessToday's 165,500 on the same day.
    - The CJP reappeared within minutes as "Cockroach is Back" (@Cockroachisback). Wikipedia
    - Dipke challenged the block in the Delhi High Court (26 May). Wikipedia
    - A Supreme Court plea seeking a CBI probe into the CJP, and an Allahabad HC (Lucknow) PIL by a Karnataka BJP worker seeking NIA/ED probes and Dipke's extradition, were both dismissed. Wikipedia
- **Disinformation:**
    - Union minister Sukanta Majumdar claimed 49% of followers were Pakistani. Dipke's screen recording showed over 94% were Indian. Wikipedia
    - Kiren Rijiju alluded to followers from "Pakistan & George Soros gang". Wikipedia
    - TraceX Labs (reported by The Hindu) flagged a fake "Cockroach Janta Party" Android app with spyware or RAT-like behaviour. Wikipedia

2. Day-by-day timeline at Jantar Mantar and beyond

Date (2026)	Events	Crowd (source type)	Police / state action	Hunger-strike day
12 May	NTA cancels NEET-UG (held 3 May); CBI probe ordered businesstoday indiatvnews	—	—	—
15–16 May	CJI remark; CJP founded Wikipedia dainikjagranmpcg	—	—	—
21 May	X account withheld in India	—	MeitY Section 69A order	—
6 Jun (Sat)	First street protest; slogan "We asked for Make in India, you gave us Leak in India"; Wangchuk attends; 7-day ultimatum to Pradhan thestatesman	"Hundreds" (Al Jazeera, Statesman/UNI); "a few dozen students" (Outlook, retrospective) outlookindia Al Jazeera	One-time exemption, 10am–5pm (New Delhi District Police letter); about 5,000 personnel in New Delhi district (per Wikipedia summary of reports). AIYF/AISF allege RSS-linked harassment thestatesman Wikipedia	—
11 Jun	Nationwide campaign launched at SPPU Pune; "exam manifesto" with ₹10,000 compensation demand	—	—	—
14 Jun	Hyderabad protest (AP photo) Al Jazeera	—	—	—
20 Jun (Sat)	Second protest from 1pm; Dipke refuses to leave after 5pm; thalis banged; indefinite sit-in	"Hundreds", mostly students	Police declare the protest past permitted hours; CJP alleges water, lights, food and washroom access cut, later restored; police tried to	—

Date (2026)	Events	Crowd (source type)	Police / state action	Hunger-strike day
	begins Wikipedia CNN		disperse, then withdrew. Volunteer Mohammad Junaid later alleged he was picked up, held for about 6 hours and dropped in Dehradun Wikipedia dynamitenews	
~23 Jun	Pradhan (to NDTV) calls the CJP a "B-team of terrorists"; Dipke responds on day 4 of the sit-in yahoo dainikjagranmpcg	"Hundreds" camping (Yahoo/Independent) yahoo	—	—
28 Jun	Wangchuk begins indefinite fast with 6 AISA students (incl. Neha Bora) and independent student Hamad Wikipedia	"Hundreds" (The Federal) thefederal	CJP alleges water and sanitation cut again thefederal	Day 1
9 Jul	CJP announces 20 July Parliament march (PTI/The Hindu) Wikipedia	—	—	Day 12
17 Jul	Wangchuk has lost 9.1 kg; 1,800+ signatories appeal to him to end the fast; Delhi HC petition	—	Government tells HC it will intervene if his health worsens	Day 20
18 Jul	Police remove Wangchuk to Safdarjung Hospital (police: on medical advice and per HC directions; CJP: "kidnapping"); Dipke starts a fast and	—	Leadership change in Delhi Police reported; barricades removed	Day 21

Date (2026)	Events	Crowd (source type)	Police / state action	Hunger-strike day
	alleges he was beaten and detained; SFI leaders join the fast Wikipedia			
19 Jul	Crowds swell ahead of the march	“Thousands” (Tribune live blog)	300+ personnel at the site with conveyor-belt bag scanners, frisking, plain-clothes officers and riot vehicles with tear-gas mounts (ThePrint); DCP Sachin Sharma: no permission sought or granted, Section 163 BNSS in force theprint	Day 22
20 Jul (Mon)	“Sansad Chalo” march on Monsoon Session Day 1; Dipke ends his fast; 3 AISA fasters end theirs; Das and Ranka meet J.P. Nadda Wikipedia	“More than 10,000” (Al Jazeera/AP/Reuters); “tens of thousands” (Guardian, Deccan Herald, CJP) Wikipedia Al Jazeera	Lathi charges, tear gas at Parliament Street, Patel Chowk and Rail Bhawan; RAF fired 7 pellet rounds (5 hit people, per Indian Express); nail-fitted batons (Alt News/BOOM verified); internet suspended; 5,000+ personnel and 25+ CAPF battalions (India.com); stage and tents dismantled Wikipedia	Day 23
21 Jul	Protesters rebuild the camp in the rain; Delhi HC orders Wangchuk moved to Medanta, Gurugram; Rahul Gandhi, Kharge and other MPs protest outside the PM’s residence and are detained Wikipedia PBS	—	20 CRPF companies airlifted from Kolkata (MHA order); 16 then 17 metro stations closed	Day 24

Date (2026)	Events	Crowd (source type)	Police / state action	Hunger-strike day
22 Jul	ASG S.V. Raju tells Delhi HC that videos show stone-throwing; HC declines urgent hearing ("Don't drag us into it"); about 65 opposition MPs write to Wangchuk; 2 ACPs and 4 other personnel reported hurt by stones; Parliament adjourned for a 4th day Wikipedia	—	Minister Jitendra Singh says 4 talk proposals sent since 22 Jul	Day 25
23 Jul	Wangchuk ends his fast after 26 days in the presence of Nadda and Jitendra Singh after written assurances (cases withdrawn, compensation, debate on leaks); Dipke vows to continue; MEA "no information" on foreign funding; PM announces fast-track courts	—	18 metro stations closed on 24 Jul	Ended (26 days)
24 Jul	Government source: resigning "equates to running away" christiandaily	Protest continues; Kolkata solidarity march altnews	Checkpoints about 5 km out (Ranka alleges) outlookindia	—
25 Jul (Sat)	Pradhan announces his resignation on X after talks with the CJP (NBC News), with a letter to	"Lakhs" galvanised overall (Outlook); "hundreds" celebrating on site	Police report a Special CP and 2 officers hurt by stones, followed by lathi charge and tear gas	—

Date (2026)	Events	Crowd (source type)	Police / state action	Hunger-strike day
	“young friends”; joint press conference with Nadda and Singh; CJP calls off protest; site swept clean			
~28 Jul	CJP says 100+ protesters arrested nationwide (Delhi, Assam, West Bengal, Bihar) despite assurances wagingnonviolence	—	Police later allege 2,873 people with criminal antecedents were present 20–25 Jul	—
18 Aug	Supreme Court constitutes High-Powered Enquiry Committee (HPEC) under Justice R. Subhash Reddy tribuneindia siasat	—	—	—
10 Sep	SC refuses to reconstitute the HPEC (order uploaded later) siasat	—	—	—
1 Oct	Delhi Police deny permission for a Jantar Mantar protest (challenged in HC) thedailyjagran	—	—	—
9 Oct	SC hearing calls for rethink of Jantar Mantar as the protest site thedailyjagran	—	45 metro stations’ gates shut from 9pm (ETV Bharat); mobile internet suspended within 4 km of Jantar Mantar, 10pm 9 Oct – 10pm 10 Oct	—

Date (2026)	Events	Crowd (source type)	Police / state action	Hunger-strike day
10 Oct (Sat)	Anti-SIR "Jantar Mantar" mobilisation against CEC Gyanesh Kumar; Dipke, Das and Ranka detained aboard an Air India plane on landing; Dhruv Rathee, Neha Bora, Dipankar Bhattacharya, Prashant Bhushan detained; Mamata Banerjee, Kejriwal and Vijayan shown detained Al Jazeera	Detentions: ~2,000 (MHA official via Reuters/Al Jazeera, which also says "more than 2,000" including politicians, journalists and lawyers); ~2,500 (Delhi Police sources via The Hindu); ~3,000 (Tribune sources); 5,900 rising to 7,000+ (Zee); 15,000 (CJP claim); ~600 arrested in Mumbai (ANI)	Deployment: 20,000+ (PTI via Ratopati); 25,000+ (ETV Bharat); 30,000+ (IPS); 35,000+ (Tribune); ~43,000 Delhi Police (Zee, from a TV programme); 300+ UP women police; anti-riot vehicles with tear-gas launchers Al Jazeera + 2	—
11 Oct	Executive magistrate releases Dipke and others ("no breach of peace for one year") Al Jazeera	—	Commissioner Anurag Kumar signs standing order de-notifying Jantar Mantar business-standard	—
12 Oct	Order made public; new sites: Ramlila Maidan (3 km), CBD Ground Shahdara (12 km), Burari (23 km); Opposition "March for Democracy" to SC stopped at Bhagwan Dass Road business-standard	—	Delhi Police get 300 social-media posts taken down for "rumours" (Business Standard) business-standard	—
13 Oct	Das, Ranka, Shinde plus 11 others (police) / about 20 (Al Jazeera) "breach" the de-notified site via private premises	—	FIR 128/26 at PS Parliament Street (BNS 221/115(2)/132/121(1)/3(5)); second FIR at Connaught Place; "preventive arrest" india	—

Date (2026)	Events	Crowd (source type)	Police / state action	Hunger-strike day
14 Oct	SEM at Mandir Marg remands Das and Ranka to 5 days' judicial custody (Tihar); Shinde released on bond; Rahul Gandhi calls it "an act of cowardice" india	—	—	—
15 Oct	HPEC portal (hpec.nic.in) launched; MHA says priorities are pellet guns, targeting of women, and property damage theprint tribuneindia	—	—	—
16 Oct	"Lehra Do Tiranga" march, Connaught Place; Dipke detained at home (20+ police, 2 notices); Bora detained at Mandi House theprint	~150 detained (police); "more than 100" (Fair Observer) theprint	Taken to Jafarpur Kalan PS; Section 163 BNSS; Central Park closed theprint	—
19 Oct	Custody extended by 2 days; cases moved to Crime Branch Inter-State Cell	—	—	—
21 Oct	Das and Ranka released after 7 days; SEM Ritu Raj rejects 3-day extension; ₹50,000 bonds and an undertaking not to call Jantar Mantar	—	—	—

Date (2026)	Events	Crowd (source type)	Police / state action	Hunger-strike day
	protests thelogicalindian			
23 Oct / 5 Nov	Crime Branch questioning, Rajouri Garden: about 4 hours, about 70 questions (PTI) telanganatoday theweek	—	—	—
5 Nov	SC directs HPEC to file its first fact-finding report within a month; notes few complaints received; L.R. Bishnoi relieved from the panel barandbench lawtrend	—	—	—
~6 Nov	Union minister Jitendra Singh alleges CJP is funded from “unauthorised sources”; Ranka responds “Why were you negotiating with us then?” theweek	—	—	—
7 Nov	“Jantar Mantar @ Kochi” march, Marine Drive to Rajendra Maidan, led by Prakash Raj theweek	~500 (organisers)	Police regulate traffic only theweek	—

3. Government response

- **Concessions:**
  - NEET-UG cancelled and handed to the CBI (12 May). Wikipedia The re-test was held on 21 June at 5,440 centres, with about 20 lakh appearing (secondary source).

businesstoday righttoinformation

  - Written assurances to Wangchuk (23 July). Wikipedia
  - PM-announced fast-track courts and a stricter paper-leak law. The Wikipedia infobox lists a Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Act, 2026; Wikipedia independent confirmation is needed.
  - Pradhan's resignation (25 July). Wikipedia Outlook's metadata names Pralhad Joshi as the new Education Minister. outlookindia
  - An agreement to withdraw cases in NDA-ruled states and pay "maximum compensation per the rules". Wikipedia christiandaily
- **Refusals and narratives:**
  - "B-team of terrorists" (Pradhan). Wikipedia thewire
  - Soros/Pakistan insinuations (Rijiju, Majumdar). Wikipedia
  - Resignation "equates to running away" (a government source, 24 July). christiandaily
  - In October: "anarchic elements" and a "flop show" (BJP's Sambit Patra), Al Jazeera "group of hooligans" (Shivraj Singh Chouhan), and foreign-funding claims (Jitendra Singh). Al Jazeera + 2
  - India's UN mission in Geneva called UN concerns "unwarranted interference". Al Jazeera
- **Institutional moves:** an MHA committee recommended alternative protest venues, leading to the de-notification of Jantar Mantar; Delhi Police told the HC this followed the SC's 9 October hearing. business-standard thedailyjagran

4. Police response and tactics (documented vs. alleged)

Tactic	Date(s)	Status
Permission limited to 10am–5pm, "one-time exemption"	6 Jun, 20 Jun	Documented (police letter, The Statesman) thestatesman
Lights, water, food and washroom access cut at the site	20 Jun, 28 Jun	CJP allegation; reported live by Dynamite News; access later restored thefederal dynamitenews
No force used; police withdrew	6 Jun, 20 Jun night	Reported (Wikipedia citing media)
Bag scanners, frisking, plain-clothes officers, QRTs, inter-state border checks	19–20 Jul	Documented (ThePrint, senior officer quoted) theprint
Section 163 BNSS (assemblies of 5+ banned)	20 Jul; 16 Oct	Documented (DCP X post) theprint
Lathi charge, tear gas	20 Jul, 25 Jul	Documented by AP, Reuters, Al Jazeera and police statements theprint asiaone
Pellet guns (RAF, 7 rounds, 5 hits; 3 named victims including an Outlook journalist)	20 Jul	Indian Express, Newslaundry; under HPEC review Wikipedia tribuneindia
Nail-fitted batons	20 Jul	Police denied; Alt News and BOOM found the videos authentic Wikipedia
Electric shock batons	20 Jul	Dainik Bhaskar video report; unverified Wikipedia
Officer slapping a woman (Addl DCP Sandeep Lamba); baton toward a woman's groin (Inspector Naveen Rathi)	20 Jul	Video and press reports; cited in PIL; Saket Gokhale filed an FIR complaint Wikipedia
Missing name badges; plain-clothes men with batons	20 Jul	Media reports newslaundry Wikipedia
RAF IG says force "did not align with prescribed standards"	Post-20 Jul	ThePrint, quoting an officer at an internal meeting Wikipedia
Internet shutdowns; metro closures (5 → 16 → 17 → 18 stations in July; 45 in October)	Jul, Oct	Documented (DMRC, ETV Bharat) Al Jazeera Wikipedia

Tactic	Date(s)	Status
Mass preventive detention; detention aboard an aircraft; buses used to remove protesters	10 Oct	Documented (Al Jazeera/Reuters/AP) Al Jazeera
Water cannon, drones, kettling	—	**No credible source found**; do not chart

5. Politicians

- **Opposition:**
  - Rahul Gandhi wrote to the Home Minister about assaults on women students, led an MPs' sit-in outside the PM's residence (21 July) where he was detained, Wikipedia and called the October jailing "cowardice". india Wikipedia
  - Kharge: "Muzzled Democracy". Al Jazeera
  - Shashi Tharoor called the CJP a "revelation" and questioned the lathi charge. Wikipedia + 2
  - Akhilesh Yadav (SP): de-notification is the BJP's "biggest defeat". business-standard
  - TMC (Mamata and Abhishek Banerjee, Derek O'Brien, Mahua Moitra, Kirti Azad) backed the CJP. Wikipedia
  - AAP's Kejriwal criticised the police; Saket Gokhale filed a complaint. Wikipedia Wikipedia
  - CPI(ML) Liberation: "Close Jantar Mantar, and thousands of Jantar Mantars will emerge." business-standard
  - Jairam Ramesh: "Demokursi". business-standard
  - About 65 MPs (Brittas, Tharoor, Ram Gopal Yadav, Sagarika Ghose, Sibal) wrote to Wangchuk. Wikipedia
  - Parliament was disrupted for at least 4 consecutive days, with the opposition demanding the resignation before any debate. Wikipedia
- **BJP/NDA:** Pradhan, Rijiju, Majumdar, Patra and Chouhan as above. Kangana Ranaut and Hema Malini questioned the protests' purpose. Wikipedia Nadda and Jitendra Singh were the negotiators. Wikipedia The RSS said differing opinions should not come "as a shock" (The Statesman). thestatesman
- **Civil society and celebrities:** Wangchuk ("honorary cockroach"), Prashant Bhushan, Anna Hazare, Anjali Bhardwaj, Wikipedia Yogendra Yadav, Arundhati Roy, fairobserver Prakash Raj, Shabana Azmi, Arijit Singh, Anurag Kashyap, Alia Bhatt, Salman Khan, Alakh Pandey, Kunal Kamra and Dhruv Rathee. outlookindia Wikipedia
- **International:** UN Human Rights Office spokesperson Thameen Al-Kheetan, Amnesty International, CPJ; Al Jazeera diaspora solidarity protests in New York, San Jose, London and Dublin. Wikipedia

6. Media framing and communication

- **Mainstream TV:** initially absent or dismissive. Newslaundry documented "Go back, Godi media" chants on 6 June. Alt News documented heckling of NDTV, News X, ABP and Times Now crews. newslaundry altnews A Countercurrents op-ed (Nov) argues TV framed protests

as threats to public order. countercurrents Organiser (RSS-affiliated) led with police injuries ("Over 118 police personnel hurt"). organiser

- **Independent and digital outlets:** Newslaundry (photo essay, stone-truck investigation), The Wire (nail batons, Pradhan coverage), The Caravan (on-the-ground account of the march), Scroll, Outlook (ground report), Alt News and BOOM (verification). outlookindia + 2
- **Fact-checks and misinformation:**
  - The Quint debunked an old February 2026 video passed off as CJP protesters ejecting "Godi media". thequint
  - Alt News and BOOM verified the nail-baton videos. Wikipedia
  - The Newslaundry truck trace showed the truck in police custody since 16 July (FIR 65/2026). Wikipedia
  - The Pakistan-followers claim was rebutted. Wikipedia
  - Spyware app warning (TraceX Labs, via The Hindu). Wikipedia
- **Foreign media:** AP, Reuters, Guardian (explainer and live blog), FT, DW, WSJ, BBC, CNN, NBC, Time and France 24. France 24 and CNN called the protests the largest against the government in years. Wikipedia Chinese state media gave no significant coverage (Tribune). Wikipedia tribuneindia
- **CJP's own channels:** Instagram as the primary platform; X (@Cockroachisback after the block); Dipke's Instagram videos (including from the aircraft on 10 Oct); Al Jazeera live posts by Das, Ranka and Ratna Singh; #MainBhiCockroach; Wikipedia a refusal to engage "godi media". india + 2 Police communicated via the DCP New Delhi X account (no-permission notices, "do not fall prey to rumours", the truck rebuttal) and PTI-distributed statements. Wikipedia theprint

7. Legal proceedings

- Delhi HC: X-block challenge (26 May); Wikipedia Gitanjali J. Angmo v. Union of India (Wangchuk moved to Medanta, 21 July); Wikipedia PILs on excessive force (urgent hearing declined 22 July; listed 11 Sept); challenge to the 1 October denial. thedailyjagran Wikipedia
- Supreme Court: CJI Kant refused urgent listing of a brutality plea ("we don't have time to watch" videos). Wikipedia Orders of 18 August (HPEC), 10 September (no reconstitution) and 5 November (report within a month). Wikipedia + 2
- HPEC members: Justice R. Subhash Reddy (chair), Ravi Shankar Jha, Shalinder Kaur, Rishi Kumar Shukla, and L.R. Bishnoi (relieved 5 Nov). theprint lawtrend
- SEM proceedings (Mandir Marg), October: remand, extension, release on ₹50,000 bonds. tribuneindia + 4
- Supreme Court petition by volunteer Mohammad Junaid (alleged abduction to Dehradun). Wikipedia

8. Geography and context for mapping

- Jantar Mantar Road is about 1 km from Parliament House. business-standard
- Flashpoints on 20 July: Mandi House → Parliament Street, Patel Chowk, Rail Bhawan, Constitution Club, Shastri Bhavan, Palika Bazar (pellet injuries), Gurdwara Bangla Sahib (refuge), RML Hospital (injured). imnindia Wikipedia
- Police stations: Parliament Street, Connaught Place, Mandir Marg (SEM court), Jafarpur Kalan (Dipke, 16 Oct); Crime Branch, Rajouri Garden. telanganatoday + 3

- Metro stations closed before 20 July: Udyog Bhawan, Central Secretariat, Patel Chowk, Janpath, Rajiv Chowk. Wikipedia
- New protest sites after de-notification: Ramlila Maidan, CBD Ground (Shahdara), Burari. business-standard
- Site rules: the SC's July 2018 judgment in *Mazdoor Kisan Shakti Sangathan v. Union of India* lets police cap Jantar Mantar gatherings (up to 5,000); the standing order sets 10am–5pm hours and applications are due 10 days in advance. business-standard + 2
- Precedents: Boat Club (Tikait, 1988), Anna Hazare (2011), wrestlers (2023, about 700 detained when cleared). The CJP's 6 June event was described as the first major Jantar Mantar demonstration since the wrestlers. Wikipedia + 3

Consolidated data points (for CSV)

Date	Metric	Value	Claimant (category)	Source (outlet, date)
2026-05-03	NEET-UG candidates (registered)	22.79 lakh, righttoinformation 5,400+ centres	NTA (official)	NTA notice of 12 May via Deccan Herald; righttoinformation.wiki
2026-05-12	NEET-UG candidates affected	22 lakh+ businesstoday	Media	BusinessToday, 12 May
2026-05-19 (approx.)	Instagram followers, 78 hrs after launch	3 million	Media	BusinessToday, 21 May
2026-05-20	Instagram followers	9 million+ (vs BJP ~8.7 million)	Media	BusinessToday, 21 May
2026-05-20	Followers gained in 24 hrs	3.7 million	Media	The Tribune, 20 May
2026-05-21	X followers	165,500 (disputed vs ~90,000 / ~200,000)	Media	BusinessToday, 21 May
2026-05-21	X followers when blocked	~90,000	Officials via media	Indian Express (via Wikipedia)
2026-05-22	Instagram followers	20 million+	Media	Economic Times (via Wikipedia)
2026-05	Online sign-ups	350,000+	CJP claim	Al Jazeera
2026-05	Share of Indian audience	>94%	CJP (Dipke screen recording)	Wikipedia
2026-05	Share of Pakistani followers	49%	Union minister (government)	Wikipedia
2026-06-06	Crowd	Hundreds	Media	Al Jazeera, 6 Jun

Date	Metric	Value	Claimant (category)	Source (outlet, date)
2026-06-06	Police deployed, New Delhi district	~5,000	Media	Wikipedia summary
2026-06-06	Permitted hours	10:00–17:00 thestatesman	Delhi Police (official)	The Statesman, 6 Jun
2026-06-20	Crowd	Hundreds	Media	Wikipedia/Deccan Herald
2026-06-21	NEET re-test appearing	~20 lakh, 5,440 centres righttoinformation	Secondary	righttoinformation.wiki
2026-07-17	Wangchuk weight loss	9.1 kg (day 19–20)	Doctor via media	BBC (via Wikipedia)
2026-07-17	Appeal signatories	1,800+	Media	BBC (via Wikipedia)
2026-07-19	Police at site	300+	Delhi Police (official)	ThePrint, 20 Jul
2026-07-20	Marchers	>10,000 Al Jazeera	Media	Al Jazeera/AP/Reuters, 20 Jul
2026-07-20	Marchers	Tens of thousands Wikipedia	Media / CJP	Guardian, Deccan Herald; CJP
2026-07-20	Security deployed	5,000+ plus 25+ CAPF battalions	Media	India.com
2026-07-20	Police injured	118+ (later 130+) theprint Wikipedia	Delhi Police (official)	Delhi Police statement via India.com and ThePrint/PTI, 20 Jul
2026-07-20	Protesters injured	~60	Delhi Police (official)	ThePrint/PTI, 20 Jul
2026-07-20	Injured at RML Hospital emergency by 5.30pm	~100 (incl. 10 police; 4 protesters in ICU)	Media (hospital sources)	Newslaundry, 21 Jul, citing Indian Express

Date	Metric	Value	Claimant (category)	Source (outlet, date)
2026-07-20	Medico-legal cases at RML by 7pm	65	Hospital via media	Wikipedia
2026-07-20	Protesters hospitalised	~150	CJP claim	Wikipedia
2026-07-20	Detained	~70	Delhi Police (PTI) / CJP	ThePrint/PTI, Telangana Today, 20 Jul
2026-07-20	Detained	0 (denial) Wikipedia	Delhi Police (later statement)	Wikipedia
2026-07-20	Government vehicles damaged	15–20 Wikipedia	Delhi Police (official)	Wikipedia
2026-07-20	Pellet rounds fired / hits	7 / 5 Wikipedia	Media	Indian Express (via Wikipedia)
2026-07-20	Metro stations closed	5	DMRC	Wikipedia
2026-07-21	CRPF companies airlifted	20	MHA (official)	Wikipedia
2026-07-22	Metro stations closed	17	DMRC	Wikipedia
2026-07-22	Opposition MPs' letter to Wangchuk	~65 MPs	Media	ThePrint (via Wikipedia)
2026-07-24	Metro stations closed	18	DMRC	Wikipedia
2026-07-23	Hunger strike duration	26 days (28 Jun–23 Jul)	Media	NBC, 25 Jul
2026-07-25	Agitation length	36 days (sit-in) / 49 days (from 6 Jun)	Media	Outlook, Al Jazeera, 25 Jul; Wikipedia

Date	Metric	Value	Claimant (category)	Source (outlet, date)
		christiandaily		
2026-07-28 (approx.)	Protesters arrested nationwide after deal	100+	CJP claim	Waging Nonviolence
2026-07-20 to 25	People with criminal antecedents present	2,873	Delhi Police (official)	Wikipedia
2026-10-09/10	Metro stations closed	45	DMRC via media	ETV Bharat
2026-10-10	Security deployed	20,000+ / 25,000+ / 30,000+ / 35,000+ / ~43,000 tribuneindia ratopati	PTI / ETV Bharat / IPS / Tribune / Zee	Various
2026-10-10	Detained (Delhi)	~2,000	MHA official	Reuters via Al Jazeera, 10 Oct
2026-10-10	Detained (Delhi)	~2,500	Delhi Police sources	The Hindu via Al Jazeera
2026-10-10	Detained (Delhi)	~3,000	Police sources	The Tribune, 11 Oct
2026-10-10	Detained (Delhi)	5,900 → 7,000+	Media sources	Zee News
2026-10-10	Detained (Delhi)	~15,000	CJP claim	Zee News
2026-10-10	Arrested (Mumbai)	~600	Media	ANI via Al Jazeera
2026-10-10	UP women police deployed	300+	Media	The Tribune
2026-10-12	Social posts taken down	300	Delhi Police (official)	Business Standard

Date	Metric	Value	Claimant (category)	Source (outlet, date)
2026-10-12	Years as designated protest site	33	Media	Daily Jagran
2026-10-13	People breaching site	14 (police) / ~20 (Al Jazeera)	Official / media	Hans India; Al Jazeera
2026-10-14 to 21	Days in judicial custody (Das, Ranka)	7	Court via media	India TV, LiveLaw
2026-10-16	Detained, Tiranga march	~150	Delhi Police (official)	ThePrint/PTI, 16 Oct
2026-10-21	Bail bond	₹50,000 each thelogicalindian	Court	The Tribune, 5 Nov
2026-11-05	Questions at Crime Branch	~70 in ~4 hrs	Police sources	ThePrint/PTI, 5 Nov
2026-11-07	Kochi marchers	~500	CJP (organisers)	The Week, 7 Nov

Disputed or unverified claims

- **20 July violence:** police say stone-pelting came first; protesters and CJP videos say police threw stones or charged peaceful crowds. Wikipedia The ASG cited the “stone truck”, which Newslaundry showed was in police custody. Wikipedia
- **20 July detentions:** police said about 70, then denied any detentions. Wikipedia + 2
- **Injury counts:** police 118 → 130+ vs. protesters about 60 (police) and about 150 (CJP). The RML figure of about 100 (Newslaundry, citing Indian Express hospital sources) includes 10 police, so it should not be read as “100+ protesters”.
- **Crowd sizes:** “tens of thousands” vs. “more than 10,000”. No sourced figure was found for a CJP claim of about 20,000 before 20 July, or for 1,000–2,000 police personnel; mark as unverified if used.
- **X follower counts:** about 90,000 (at blocking), 165,500 (BusinessToday, 21 May) and about 200,000 (BBC) conflict.
- **10 October detentions and deployments:** they vary by a factor of about 7. Al Jazeera india
- **Foreign funding:** alleged by Jitendra Singh; MEA said it had “no information”; Wikipedia the CJP denies it. theweek
- **Vijeta Dahiya’s removal** as spokesperson (reportedly for a fast-food break during the clashes): Wikipedia a single Wikipedia-sourced claim; treat as unverified.

- **An ink attack on Dipke** by a woman chanting Hindutva slogans (mid-July): Wikipedia Wikipedia-sourced only.
- **Wikipedia's infobox** marks the outcome "successful" and lists a 2026 amendment act; several entries carry "failed verification" tags. Wikipedia

Recommendations for the D3.js build

1. **Use two phases:** Phase 1 runs 16 May – 25 July (education); Phase 2 runs 9 Oct – present (SIR/CEC). Shade the gap (August–September: legal track) differently.
2. **Plot every claim as its own point**, colour-coded by claimant (CJP, police/official, media, government/opposition), with range bars for detentions on 10 October and injuries on 20 July rather than a single bar.
3. **Show hunger-strike days as a horizontal bar** (28 June – 23 July, 26 days) with weight-loss and hospital-transfer annotations.
4. **Build a map layer** with Jantar Mantar, Parliament, the 20 July flashpoints, closed metro stations, police stations and the three replacement protest sites with distances.
5. **Draw an escalation ladder** for police tactics using the documented/alleged table above, and exclude water cannon, drones and kettling (no sources found).
6. **Add a follower-growth sparkline** (3M → 9M → 20M → 22M) labelled "organiser/media-reported", since there is no platform-verified data.

Caveats and evidence gaps

- Several figures rely on Wikipedia summaries of primary reports (The Hindu, Indian Express, BBC); verify against the originals before publishing.
- No official Delhi Police deployment figures were found for 6 June beyond secondary summaries, and none for barricade layers on any date.
- No hashtag-trend analytics or platform-verified reach data exist in the sources found.
- The HPEC's findings are not yet public; its first report was due about one month after 5 November. barandbench
- Some outlets (Organiser; Zee figures taken from a TV programme; Countercurrents op-ed) have clear editorial positions; they are labelled accordingly.
- One outlet (Christian Daily) misdates the resignation to 2025; disregard. christiandaily